Dinkum: every feature

Grouped by section. Each section ends with ideas for improvement. Working name; prototype covers Newtown, Enmore and Marrickville.

1. Getting started

The first screens a diner sees.

Feature	What it does
Home page	Hero with a live example: the local main with the biggest gap between apps, shown as a price strip.
Home search	Search a cuisine, dish or restaurant straight from the home page, with suggestions as you type.
Address entry	Autocomplete from Google Places when a key is set, otherwise OpenStreetMap (Photon), then a built-in street list.
Unit numbers	"5/120 King St" is split so the unit is kept but the street is still found.
Delivery radius	Only restaurants that deliver to the address are shown.
Memberships	One-time question: do you have DashPass or Uber One? Totals then use member fees.

Ideas for improvement

- Use my location button, so phone users skip typing.
- Remember a couple of saved addresses (home, work).
- Make the home example rotate between suburbs and cuisines.
- Ask for memberships later, only when a cart is built, to shorten sign-up.

2. Browsing restaurants

Finding a place to eat.

Feature	What it does
Picture-first cards	Photo, name, cuisine, suburb and distance on every card.
Saving badge	Each card shows the average % saved by ordering the cheapest way.
Search with suggestions	One box replaces the tags: suggests cuisines, dishes and restaurants. Empty box lists cuisines.
Cuisine filter chip	Picking a cuisine adds a chip that is cleared with one tap.
Sort and filters	Sort by saving or distance; filters stay visible whenever there are results.
Sponsor slots	Space for a marked banner or featured restaurant (empty for now).

Ideas for improvement

- Open now / closing soon labels from opening hours.
- Price level ($ to $$$) and dietary filters (vegan, gluten-free, halal).
- A map view for people who choose by distance.
- Favourites, so regulars find their places in one tap.

3. Restaurant page

Comparing a menu item by item.

Feature	What it does
Compact header	Name, photo, cuisine, distance and the best way to order, without crowding.
Price strip	Each dish shows in-store, pickup, direct, Uber Eats and DoorDash as dots on one line, prices above.
"= In-store price" badge	Marks channels that charge the counter price. Expensive delivery is highlighted.
Modifiers	Sizes and add-ons, with their own price per channel; blank means not offered.
Recommendation	A plain-English line: the cheapest way, or the lowest app price if you want delivery.
Ranked order bars	The whole order ranked by total, shared with the cart.

Ideas for improvement

- "Last checked on [date]" per restaurant so diners trust the prices.
- Most-ordered dishes pinned to the top of the menu.
- Restaurant-supplied photos per dish.
- A small "why the gap?" explainer that is fair to restaurants (commission).

4. Cart and ordering

Turning a choice into an order.

Feature	What it does
Cart	Items from one restaurant at a time, with quantities and modifiers.
Phone cart bar	Sticky bar on phones: item count, best total and the saving.
Full totals	Item prices plus delivery and service fees, promos and membership discounts, GST included.
Promotions	Percent off, dollars off, free delivery and buy-one-get-one, applied in the ranking.
Pickup and direct	Pickup and the restaurant site are ranked next to the apps.
Hand-off	One tap opens the chosen app or site. Dinkum never takes payment.
Order confirmation	After the hand-off, asks if the order went through and records the saving.

Ideas for improvement

- From friends' feedback: re-entering the order and logging in at the restaurant are the main drop-off points.
- Open Uber Eats and DoorDash in the installed app, where people are usually already logged in.
- Keep a "Your order" checklist on screen during the hand-off, with item names spelled as the app shows them.
- Mark restaurants whose site allows guest checkout ("No sign-up") and rank them a little higher; add tap-to-call for pickup.
- Carry the cart over to restaurant sites on the two or three ordering systems most pilot restaurants use.
- A hand-off sheet for restaurant sites too: the item checklist plus name, mobile and address with Copy buttons for guest checkout. Details stay on the phone; Dinkum never takes the order or payment.
- Ask "Did your order go through?" on return, with quick reasons if not (had to make an account, too slow to re-add items), to measure drop-off.
- Parked: a Dinkum checkout. Revisit only if drop-off stays high after these fixes.
- Show estimated delivery times next to price, and a running "you have saved $__" total.

5. Dish search

One dish across every restaurant.

Feature	What it does
Dish page	Every restaurant that sells a dish, ranked, with the cheapest way for each.
Smart matching	Synonyms (phad thai = pad thai) and protein flags so chicken and tofu are told apart.
Filters and sort	Vegetarian toggle; sort by cheapest or closest.
Shareable link	Each dish has its own link (#dish-pad-thai) to send to friends.
View menu	Rows open the restaurant page instead of adding to cart, since an order is one restaurant.

Ideas for improvement

- Group by price band (under $15, $15 to $20, over $20).
- Suggest similar dishes when there are few results.
- Save a dish to get told when it is cheaper somewhere new.

6. Trust and feedback

Keeping prices honest.

Feature	What it does
Wrong-price reports	Diners flag a price; it is sent to a Google Form, by email, or kept on the device.
Mismatch follow-up	After an order: "What was different?" captures the real price paid.
Estimated labels	Clear wording where a price is estimated rather than checked.

Ideas for improvement

- Set up the Google Form so reports reach you (not yet connected).
- Item-level reports with a photo of the receipt or app screen.
- Let restaurants claim and correct their own listing.

7. Data and admin

How prices get in.

Feature	What it does
Google Sheet	Tabs for restaurants, menu, modifiers, promotions and sponsors, plus a Guide tab.
Rules	0 means $0, blank means not available. Prices include GST.
Fallbacks	If the sheet is unreachable the live page uses CSV files, then an empty state; never demo data.
Demo page	A separate page with 15 made-up restaurants for showing people safely.

Ideas for improvement

- A simple form for entering a menu instead of editing the sheet.
- Highlight rows whose prices have not been checked in 30 days.
- Bulk import from a menu photo.

8. Growth and analytics

Measuring and spreading.

Feature	What it does
Analytics hooks	Ready for Plausible or Google Analytics; switched off until you add an ID.
Share links	Restaurants and dishes have links that open the right page.
Sponsors	Banner and featured slots driven by the sponsors tab.

Ideas for improvement

- Turn on Plausible (privacy-friendly, no cookie banner needed).
- Window stickers with a QR code to the restaurant page.
- Track hand-offs per channel to show restaurants their direct orders.

9. Look and feel

Applies everywhere.

Feature	What it does
Brand	Carolina blue, picture-first, light on text.
Dark mode	Follows the phone or computer setting.
Phone first	Layouts checked at phone width with no sideways scrolling.
Accessibility	Keyboard search suggestions, labelled controls, readable contrast.

Ideas for improvement

- Pick the final name and logo (see the logo canvas).
- Custom illustrations for empty states.
- Install-to-home-screen support (web app manifest).